

# Is the noise law to blame?

A European Parliament study, tested against Eurostat and WHO levels

## THE CLAIM

**“...not the cause of the noise problems in Malta.”**

Hjerp and Coffey, study for the EP Petitions Committee, February 2026

On transposition and implementation of the Environmental Noise Directive.

*Opinions are the authors', not the Parliament's.*

## VERDICT

# LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Law is not the cause; that is not 'quiet'.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY  
SUPPORTED

NOT  
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

## MAIN RESULTS

### Grade C

#### Study holds together

Two meaningful non-conformities; no END infringement case 2015–2025 (per the study).

### 31.3%

#### Highest noise in the EU

People reporting street or neighbour noise, 2023 (EU 18.1%).

### 55 dB

#### Thresholds above WHO

END reporting threshold 55 dB; WHO road level 53 dB, aircraft 45 dB.

### Outside

#### Most complaints not covered

Construction, entertainment and neighbourhood noise fall outside the Directive.

### 2025

#### Action plan late

Plan due January 2025 not published by January 2026.

## FAIR TO SAY

Malta has had no END infringement case in 2015–2025, per the study. We did not re-check the law or the survey (21% vs 9%) independently.

## WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The ERA consultation annex and survey.

☐ Complaint data on construction and entertainment noise.

☐ Date of the next Action Plan.

☐ Legal check of the transposition table.